MONTHLY UPDATE

Energy: monthly update, July 2026

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14 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

BOTSWANA · BURUNDI · DJIBOUTI · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GHANA · KENYA · MALAWI · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · SIERRA LEONE · SOUTH AFRICA · UGANDA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Botswana

The facility's power is the unusual part. On-site gas-fired generation is supplemented by solar introduced to cover periods of lower gas availability, with battery and compressed-gas storage under review — solar specified as firming for gas, the reverse of the usual diesel-backup arrangement. An initial 5 MW solar development was assessed during the quarter and an extension of the gas gathering network to connect a further production well is stated subject to funding; neither carries a capital cost, approval or date, and the company states both are work-programme items rather than guidance. The second gates the data centre: capacity growth turns on upstream gas work rather than on demand.

Burundi

Among the regulator's remedies for degraded service, named on 3 August, is a planned study on powering mobile base stations.

Djibouti

The same 19 July memorandum with LinkWise commits up to 500 MW of solar, wind and storage generation to power the AI compute zone — a figure the promoters supply.

Ethiopia

The incumbent's renewable programme reached 39.72 MW of installed solar across 190 fully solar-powered sites, 867 hybrid systems and 1,114 lithium-ion storage units, 12.72 MW of it added over the financial year, with diesel generator running time down by up to 40%. The figures are the operator's own and unaudited.

Gabon

About 22 per cent of the Nkok facility's site energy comes from a photovoltaic plant, with water-free cooling (figures given at the inauguration).

Ghana

No power purchase, tariff or on-site generation arrangement is published for any named Ghanaian data-centre facility, and a probe on 5 August found none. What is available is country-level and modelled: about 6 GW of installed capacity of which roughly half reaches the end user, electricity at about US$0.12 per kWh and independent producers at more than 60% of capacity, on 2024 estimates in an analyst brief.

Kenya

Power is what is holding the data-centre build back, and there is no rule governing it. A hyperscale project stalled on power capacity in July, against about 3 GW of installed supply and a 10 GW-by-2030 target — a single 1 GW facility would take a third of supply. No published tariff, gazetted large-load connection rule or grid-connection framework for data centres exists: every power arrangement the base holds is bilateral.

Malawi

The minister cited an 8% rise in electricity tariffs and a roughly 144% rise in fuel prices in the operators' cost case (parliamentary account).

Mauritius

Cabinet also approved for signature a memorandum with Saudi Arabia putting digital transformation and energy-sector cybersecurity alongside hydrocarbons — an approval to sign, not a signature, with no date, term, value or committed system stated.

Mozambique

The same data centre draws on grid, photovoltaic and generator supply (inauguration account).

Sierra Leone

The constraint under everything else eased slightly. A World Bank-funded 40MW solar-plus-storage project at Lungi and Newton became fully operational, commissioned in July 2026 and projected to raise the electricity access rate toward 36% and to ease the outages that interrupt telecommunications and digital services. The access projection is the project's own; no generation outturn, grid-availability series or measured effect on network uptime is held, so the connection between the plant and the services it is said to protect is asserted rather than shown.

South Africa

The grid had its best month on the utility's own reporting in six years. Eskom put the energy availability factor at 67.55%, its highest in six years, with unplanned outages down 44.5% year on year, about 1.2 million customers removed from load reduction and 505,607 smart meters installed, the Eastern Cape becoming the seventh province removed from load reduction. These are the utility's figures and no regulator or system-operator confirmation accompanies them.

It closes a build programme rather than opening one: the last unit of the two flagship stations entered commercial operation in September 2025, adding 800 MW. What the month does not settle is adequacy after 2029, which the system operator's own assessment identifies as the risk and which is carried in the progress report rather than here.

Uganda

The largest operator's 2025 sustainability report puts 45% of network sites on solar or hydro, with a 490 kWh solar plant commissioned at headquarters. The figures are the company's own and unaudited, and no prior-year share is held against which to read that share.

Zimbabwe

The listed infrastructure company commenced phase 1 of a 100 MW solar farm for its technology park, and its fuel-management system was credited with reducing energy consumption on tower sites, with no percentage, litre, cost or uptime figure given (trading update).

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